

Yitong Zhang (张奕彤)

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https://zhangyitonggg.github.io/



Education

- 2026.09 - 2031.06 (expected), Ph.D. Student, College of AI, Tsinghua University, under the supervision of Prof. [Jia Li](#)
- 2022.09 - 2026.06, Undergraduate Student, School of Computer Science and Engineering, Beihang University, under the supervision of Prof. [Xianglong Liu](#) and Prof. [Aishan Liu](#)

Research Interests

I aim to build more capable and trustworthy intelligent software systems, with a particular focus on LLM-based agents. ❶ On the capability side, I study how these systems can reason, use tools, and carry out complex, long-horizon tasks. ❷ On the trustworthiness side, I investigate how to ensure that their actions remain aligned with user intent, robust to adversarial interference, and subject to verifiable constraints as their capabilities grow.

Internships

- 2026.06 - 2026.08, Research Intern at [Ant Group](#)
- 2025.12 - 2026.03, Research Intern at [Fitten](#)

Academic Performance

- | | |
|----------------------------------|---------------------|
| Weighted Score: 95.3 /100 | Rank: 3 /241 |
| GPA: 3.90 /4.00 | Rank: 4 /241 |

Honors and Awards

- CAST Young Science and Technology Talent Cultivation Program (Doctoral Student Special Plan) (科协青年科技人才培育工程博士生专项计划)**, 2026
- Tsinghua Doctoral Fellowship for Future Scholar (清华大学未来学者奖学金; Only 4 recipients in the College of AI)**, 2026
- Shen Yuan Medal (沈元奖章; Top 0.1%; Only 10 undergraduates university-wide; The highest scholarship of Beihang University)**, 2025
- Beihang Youth May Fourth Medal (北航青年五四奖章)**, 2026
- China National Scholarship (three-time recipient)**, 2023, 2024, 2025
- CCF Elite Collegiate Award**, 2026
- Outstanding Student of Beijing**, 2025

Grants

- | | |
|---------|---|
| 2026.09 | Large Model Driven End-to-End Autonomous Driving Model Adversarial Attacks |
| 2024.10 | <ul style="list-style-type: none">Principal Investigator, Beijing Natural Science Foundation (Grant No. QY24136).One of 40 students selected university-wide. |

Selected Publications

* *indicates author with equal contribution.*

- DAVSP: Safety Alignment for Large Vision-Language Models via Deep Aligned Visual Safety Prompt
Yitong Zhang, Jia Li, Liyi Cai, Ge Li
AAAI 2026 (**Oral**), Top 4%

- › Environmental Injection Attacks against GUI Agents in Realistic Dynamic Environments
Yitong Zhang, Ximo Li, Liyi Cai, Jia Li
ISSTA 2026
- › Lookahead-then-Verify: Reliable Constrained Decoding for Diffusion LLMs under Context-Free Grammars
Yitong Zhang, Yongmin Li, Yuetong Liu, Jia Li, Xiaoran Jia, Zherui Li, Ge Li
ISSTA 2026
- › Beyond Autoregression: An Empirical Study of Diffusion Large Language Models for Code Generation
 Chengze Li*, **Yitong Zhang* (Equal Contribution)**, Jia Li, Liyi Cai, Ge Li
TOSEM
- › DiffuCD: Efficient Contrastive Decoding for Diffusion Language Models
 Jia Li, **Yitong Zhang (Student First Author)**, Zhi Jin
Journal of Software
- › To See is Not to Master: Teaching LLMs to Use Private Libraries for Code Generation
Yitong Zhang, Chengze Li, Ruize Chen, Guowei Yang, Xiaoran Jia, Yijie Ren, Jia Li
TOSEM Major Revision
- › Grammar-Constrained Decoding Can Jailbreak LLMs into Generating Malicious Code
Yitong Zhang, Shiteng Lu, Jia Li
ICSE 2027 Under Review
- › AI-Driven Self-Evolving Software: A Promising Path Toward Software Automation
 Liyi Cai*, Yijie Ren*, **Yitong Zhang* (Equal Contribution)**, Jia Li
 Preprint
- › *Additional publications can be found on my [Google Scholar profile](#).*

Teaching and Service

- › Reviewer: AAAI 2026
- › Teaching Assistant: LLM-Driven Software Development, Tsinghua University, Fall 2026, Jia Li
- › Teaching Assistant: Discrete Mathematics, Beihang University, Spring 2025, Lei Shi
- › Teaching Assistant: Computer Organization, Beihang University, Fall 2024, Han Wan
- › Senior Teaching Assistant: Data Structures and Programming, Beihang University, Spring 2024, Ying Li